

Auckland tree weta

Wetas are much larger cousins of crickets. A tree weta's body is about 1½ in (4 cm) long, but a giant weta can be 4 in (10 cm)—longer than your hand!



Auckland tree wetas can raise their spiny back legs for defense.

New Zealand

New Zealand is made up of two main islands—North and South Island—and many smaller ones. Lots of birds live here, some of which cannot fly. Unfortunately, many were killed by cats, rats, and other predators brought by European settlers. Now, rare birds such as the kakapo are protected.

